Incident 2025-031 Postmortem: Checkout outage

Summary: On 14 March 2025 checkout was unavailable for 47 minutes. Customers saw HTTP 503 errors when placing orders. The incident was classified SEV1.

Root cause: orders-svc v3.8.1 exhausted its database connection pool after a change that held connections open while calling the payments service. The pool maximum was 20 connections per pod, and slow payment authorizations kept every connection busy.

Resolution and follow-up actions

The on-call engineer rolled back to v3.8.0, which restored checkout. The fix, released in orders-svc v3.8.2, releases the connection before calling payments and raises the pool maximum to 40 connections per pod.

Action items: add an alert on connection pool saturation above 80 percent; add a load test for slow upstream dependencies; document pool sizing in the deployment runbook.